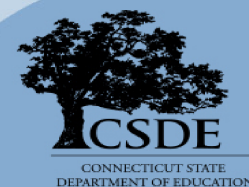


Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2021–22



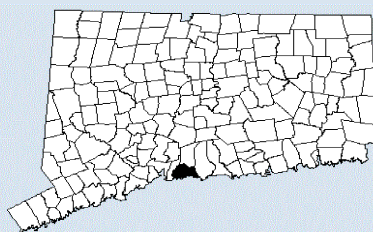
Branford School District

Mr. Hamlet Hernandez, Superintendent • 203-488-7276 • www.branfordschools.org

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	8
Enrollment	2,634
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$22,399
Total Expenditures ¹	\$59,717,022

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2020-21 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2021-22 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2021 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.5
Male	1,382	52.5	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	181	6.9	5.1
Black or African American	102	3.9	12.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	383	14.5	29.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	117	4.4	4.3
White	1,847	70.1	48.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	175	6.6	8.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	912	34.6	40.6
Students with Disabilities ³	350	13.3	16.7

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	*	*
Male	270	20.4	56	3.9
Non-Binary	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	19	19.2	6	5.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	122	32.4	29	7.0
White	335	19.0	45	2.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	35	19.4	6	3.2
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	265	30.7	50	5.1
Students with Disabilities	78	23.8	23	5.7
District	527	20.9	86	3.2
State		23.7		6.5

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 683

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Branford School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	209.7
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	39.5
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	30.9
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	88.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	6.6
School Level	12.4
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	5.0
Support Staff	3.5
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	24.9
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	21.0
School Nurses	9.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	169.4

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	2	0.6	1.3
Black or African American	3	1.0	4.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	9	2.9	4.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.2
White	297	95.5	89.2

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2020-21

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	28.1	10.4

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	28	73.7	17	77.3
White	140	94.0	143	95.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	46	79.3	58	89.2
Students with Disabilities	14	*	36	94.7
District	187	90.3	187	93.5
State		81.7		87.7

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	*	*
Emotional Disturbance	18	56.3
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	83	72.2
Other Health Impairment	48	75.0
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	40	83.3
District	210	64.0
State		68.4

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Branford School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	50	1.9	2.3
Emotional Disturbance	32	1.2	1.1
Intellectual Disability	8	0.3	0.6
Learning Disability	115	4.4	6.1
Other Health Impairment	64	2.4	3.3
Other Disabilities	28	1.1	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	55	2.1	1.9
All Disabilities	352	13.5	16.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	19	5.4	8.2
Private Schools or Other Settings	12	3.4	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2020-21

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$33,926,733	\$12,726	\$12,000
Support services - students	\$4,752,638	\$1,843	\$1,468
Support services - instruction	\$5,280,589	\$2,048	\$780
Support services - general administration	\$1,820,749	\$706	\$472
Support services - school based administration	\$2,849,409	\$1,105	\$1,103
Central and other support services	\$1,581,803	\$613	\$703
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$6,262,127	\$2,428	\$1,910
Student transportation services	\$2,357,798	\$893	\$1,287
Food services	.	.	\$28
Enterprise operations	\$885,175	\$343	\$170
Total	\$59,717,022	\$22,399	\$19,134

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2020-21

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$4,014,913	34.4	29.7
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$1,547,133	13.2	10.8
Other Salaries	\$400,075	3.4	9.8
Employee Benefits	\$1,557,498	13.3	13.8
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$525,317	4.5	5.7
Special Education Tuition	\$3,142,172	26.9	22.6
Supplies	\$58,232	0.5	0.6
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$427,397	3.7	6.3
Equipment	\$7,909	0.1	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$400	0.0	0.1
Total	\$11,681,045	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		19.6	24.5

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2020-21

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	89.5
State	6.7
Federal	3.7
Tuition & Other	0.1

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Branford School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	79	75.2	79	72.6	31	73.8
Black or African American	*	*	*	*	23	59.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	180	59.3	180	55.7	85	53.9
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	57	64.7	57	61.3	*	*
White	951	66.2	949	62.5	417	61.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	109	60.7	109	58.7	32	55.7
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	1,217	65.9	1,215	62.0	548	61.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	452	59.0	452	55.0	193	56.7
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	874	68.8	872	65.2	387	63.2
Students with Disabilities	189	44.8	186	40.2	66	45.5
Students without Disabilities	1,137	68.9	1,138	65.2	514	63.1
High Needs	588	57.6	586	53.9	239	55.9
Non-High Needs	738	71.7	738	67.9	341	64.7
District	1,326	65.4	1,324	61.7	580	61.1

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	84.4	81.6	56.6	81.0	697	75.6
Curl Up	87.7	83.7	74.7	90.5	697	84.2
Push Up	76.0	81.6	63.7	61.9	697	70.2
Mile Run/PACER	81.6	73.5	50.0	49.2	697	62.8
All Tests - District	53.6	54.4	40.1	41.8	697	47.1
All Tests - State	48.9	46.7	44.3	43.3		45.8

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Branford School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2020-21	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	8	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	30	73.3
White	138	96.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	67	85.1
Students with Disabilities	25	60.0
District	198	92.4
State		89.6

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2020-21 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	81	40.5
Male	95.1	*	*
Non-Binary	*	*	*
Black or African American	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	91.7	11	18.3
White	98.0	127	42.5
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	95.9	37	30.1
Students with Disabilities	78.2	*	*
District	96.6	159	39.1
State	95.0		43.5

³ Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴ Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2022 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2021	Class of 2020
	Entrance ⁵	Persistence ⁶
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	81.3	94.0
Male	59.4	80.0
Non-Binary	N/A	*
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	52.2	*
White	71.9	87.1
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	50.0	81.8
Students with Disabilities	32.0	*
District	69.5	88.5
State	66.1	84.9

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Branford School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	65.4	75	43.6	50	87.3	64.2
	High Needs Students	57.6	75	38.4	50	76.8	54.2
Math Performance Index	All Students	61.7	75	41.1	50	82.3	58.6
	High Needs Students	53.9	75	36.0	50	71.9	47.7
Science Performance Index	All Students	61.1	75	40.7	50	81.4	61.4
	High Needs Students	55.9	75	37.2	50	74.5	51.3
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	58.9%	100%	58.9	100	58.9	60.4%
	High Needs Students	53.2%	100%	53.2	100	53.2	56.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	63.4%	100%	63.4	100	63.4	65.2%
	High Needs Students	59.0%	100%	59.0	100	59.0	59.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	69.8%	100%	34.9	50	69.8	64.9%
	Oral	61.2%	100%	30.6	50	61.2	57.4%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	20.9%	<=5%	18.3	50	36.6	23.7%
	High Needs Students	27.4%	<=5%	5.2	50	10.3	34.0%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	91.9%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	84.8%
	% Meeting Benchmark	39.1%	75%	26.0	50	52.1	43.5%
On-track to High School Graduation		80.6%	94%	42.9	50	85.8	82.7%
4-year Graduation All Students (2021 Cohort)		92.4%	94%	98.3	100	98.3	89.6%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2019 Cohort)		88.3%	94%	93.9	100	93.9	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2021)		69.5%	75%	92.7	100	92.7	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		87.2% 47.1%	75%	15.7	50	31.4	94.0% 45.8%
Arts Access		61.4%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	52.4%
Accountability Index				1030.0	1450	71.0	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	71.7	57.6	14.0	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	67.9	53.9	13.9	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	64.7	55.9	8.8	17.4	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	88.3%	5.7%	10.2%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	99.1
	High Needs Students	99.0
Math	All Students	98.9
	High Needs Students	98.7
Science	All Students	97.9
	High Needs Students	96.2

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 52.9

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Branford School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

In 2021-22, while continuing to take measures to protect the physical health of staff and students, the Branford Public Schools focused on two main goals aligned with the District's Strategic Success plan: ensuring all students feel safe and welcome and ensuring all students have access to high quality, rigorous learning.

Action steps towards each goal included: To better address the social and emotional needs of BPS students, a Dean of Students role was re-allocated to a District-wide position as SEL Coordinator. In addition, the high school created "Hive" time, in which small groups of students meet with adult advisors for SEL and College and Career-focused lessons. Advisory in the intermediate school similarly focused on SEL, and the elementary staff began refresher training in responsive classroom practices. Instructionally, the elementary schools focused on foundational reading skills, using ReadConn; WIS and BHS on student-centered, standards-aligned, inquiry-driven instructional practice. In addition, the intermediate school continued to work towards revising its grading and assessment practices to more accurately measure and report on student learning.

To address the varied needs of students with disabilities, the District implements researched-backed interventions and practices. For example, students with dyslexia are provided intensive reading instruction using one of 19 Level-I Certified Wilson instructors. For lower-incident handicaps, the District maintains ABA-based programs for students in Pre-K and K-4 levels, life skills programs at our intermediate and high schools, and an 18-to-22-year-old transition program. To support behaviorally complex students, the District employs 4 Crisis Prevention Institute trainers to train staff in de-escalation, 4 BCBA's working as teachers and as cross-departmental consultants, and 5 RBTs. Additionally, on-staff person-center planning facilitators and a trained neurocognitive evaluator to provide enhanced evaluations to inform decision-making. Special education staff have been supported in using both macro and micro-data points to determine intervention effectiveness, need trends and leading indicators, and PD needs against which Department budgets are constructed.

District efforts at truancy prevention focus on reconnecting students to school, both through regularly scheduled instruction such as "Hive" time described above and concentrated outreach to families. A new family liaison position at the intermediate school connects families to outside agencies as needed and organized events to bring families into the school. School-based student support teams meet on a weekly basis to identify and reconnect disconnected students and families, implementing a variety of strategies, from ongoing virtual wellness check-ins to regular home visits.

Teacher conferences are both virtual and in-person, and all schools host a number of family nights, focused on educating families about the content of their children's learning and on providing strategies for families to use at home to support that learning. This year, the District hosted a series of virtual Superintendent Family Forums and used multiple pathways to communicate with the families, including the BPS website and the Talking Points app, both of which provide translation into a variety of languages spoken by BPS families.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

In 2021-22, a total of 76 Branford students were enrolled in schools of choice, including magnet and charter schools, and 49 non-resident students attended schools in the district through the Open Choice program. The District's commitment to its Choice students included ensuring that all students, regardless of home location, were able to access transportation home when participating in afterschool enrichment programs and other activities.

As the demographics of the Branford Public School community continue to evolve, the District has been striving to increase the representation of minority staff members through informal outreach and recruitment, and collaboration with our area RESC.

In 2021-22, the District maintained its commitment to Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion by continuing to expand school and classroom library collections to better reflect the diverse BPS student body and to offer readers an opportunity to explore worlds other than their own. DEI is an integral consideration in all curriculum development, including professional learning that focuses on equity-centered pedagogy. High school teachers participated in workshops to prepare them to teach the African American History and Latino Studies course for 2022-23 and to inform their curriculum development of other related courses. In addition, the high school collaborated with the Anti-Defamation League to bring "No Place for Hate" to the BHS community, and clubs at the high school and intermediate school created events designed to raise awareness and recognize the diversity of individuals and cultures in the BPS community, including those for Women's History Month, Black History Month, and LGBTQ Pride. Finally, in order to ensure that all BHS seniors had full access to senior activities, the district covered all associated costs.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Branford School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Branford School District's budget development process is designed to provide equity across schools and programs while addressing student needs. Teacher leaders, school principals, and district department leaders generate budget requests that are considered by the central office staff through the lens of equity in the allocation of resources, and with consideration for the district's emerging needs and how those needs are distributed across the different schools and programs.

As the budget process unfolds, there is additional scrutiny and ongoing communication and collaboration with school and department leaders to ensure equity across the levels. Reasonable class size continues to be a priority for the district as does the support of the district's strategic success plan and a focus on emerging needs, such as students' social and emotional learning, the inclusion and education of students with disabilities, and supporting students from diverse backgrounds.